

1. A 35-year-old male client was admitted to orthopedics emergency unit with soft tissue injury at right upper extremity.

What is the initial nursing intervention immediately after admission?

- A. Encourage elevation
- B. Apply elastic bandage
- C. Promote rest
- D. Apply cold packs

2. The client with an above the knee amputation is to use crutches until the prosthesis is properly lifted. When teaching the client about using the crutches, the nurse instructs the client to support her weight primarily on which of the following body areas?

- A. Hands
- B. Axillae
- C. Upper arms
- D. Elbows

3. While caring for a client with a newly applied plaster of Paris cast, the nurse makes note of all the following conditions. Which assessment finding requires immediate notification of the physician?

- A. Report, by client, the heat is being felt under the cast
- B. Moderate pain, as reported by the client
- C. Onset of paralysis in the toes of the casted foot
- D. Presence of slight edema of the toes of the casted foot

4. A client has just returned from surgery after having his left leg amputated below the knee. Physician's orders include elevation of the foot of the bed for 24 hours. The nurse observes that the nursing assistant has placed a pillow under the client's amputated limb. The nursing action is to:

- A. Leave the pillow and elevate the foot of the bed
- B. Remove the pillow and elevate the foot of the bed
- C. Leave the pillow as his stump is elevated
- D. Check with the physician and clarify the orders

5. After falling down the basement steps in his house, a client is brought to the emergency room. His physician confirms that his leg is fractured. Following application of a leg cast, the nurse will first check the client's toes for:

- A. Increase in the temperature
- B. Edema
- C. Change in color
- D. Movement

6. When completing the history and physical examination of a client diagnosed with osteoarthritis, which of the following would the nurse assess?

- A. Osteoporosis
- B. Anemia
- C. Weight loss
- D. Local joint pain

7. The nurse is assessing the casted extremity of a client. The nurse assesses for which of the following signs and symptoms indicative of infection?

- A. Presence of a "hot spot" on the cast
- B. Coolness and pallor of the extremity
- C. Diminished distal pulse
- D. Dependent edema

8. When admitting a client with a fractured extremity, the nurse would focus the assessment on which of the following first?

- A. The actual fracture site
- B. The area distal to the fracture
- C. The opposite extremity for baseline comparison
- D. The area proximal to the fracture

9. The client who had an open femoral fracture was discharged to her home, where she developed, fever, night sweats, chills, restlessness and restrictive movement of the fractured leg. The nurse interprets these findings as indicating which of the following?

- A. Pulmonary emboli

- B. Osteomyelitis
- C. Fat emboli
- D. Urinary tract infection

10. The client arrives in the emergency department after a motor vehicle accident. Nursing assessment findings include BP 80/34, pulse rate 120, and respirations 20. Which is the client's most appropriate priority nursing diagnosis?

- A. Alteration in cerebral tissue perfusion
- B. Fluid volume deficit
- C. Ineffective airway clearance
- D. Alteration in sensory perception

11. The client is admitted following repair of a fractured tibia and cast application. Which nursing assessment should be reported to the doctor?

- A. Pain beneath the cast
- B. Warm toes
- C. Pedal pulses weak and rapid
- D. Paresthesia of the toes

12. A nurse is caring for a patient who has had hip replacement. The nurse should be most concerned about which of the following findings?

- A. Complaints of pain during repositioning.
- B. Scant bloody discharge on the surgical dressing.
- C. Complaints of pain following physical therapy.
- D. Temperature of 101.8 F (38.7C).

13. A patient returns to the emergency department less than 24 hours after having a fiberglass cast applied for a fractured right radius. Which of the following patient complaints would cause the nurse to be concerned about impaired perfusion to the limb?

- A. Severe itching under the cast.
- B. Severe pain in the right shoulder.
- C. Severe pain in the right lower arm.
- D. Increased warmth in the fingers.

14. A client arrives in the emergency department with a suspected fracture of the left tibia. Which of the following is the priority assessment?

- A. Inspecting for signs of bruising around the fracture site
- B. Assessing for pedal pulses in the affected leg
- C. Asking about the client's pain level on a scale of 1 to 10
- D. Checking for sensation in the unaffected leg

15. A client with a fractured pelvis is at risk for which potentially life-threatening complication?

- A. Fat embolism
- B. Deep vein thrombosis
- C. Osteoporosis
- D. Hypertension

16. A client is placed in skeletal traction for a femoral fracture. Which nursing intervention is essential to prevent complications?

- A. Assessing the client's skin under the traction straps every 12 hours
- B. Removing the weights every 2 hours to promote comfort
- C. Monitoring the pin insertion sites for signs of infection
- D. Applying lotion to the skin to prevent dryness

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18. A client with osteomyelitis asks the nurse why they are being advised to limit weight-bearing activities on the affected limb. What is the nurse's best response?

- A. "Weight-bearing can increase circulation and prolong the infection."
- B. "It will prevent further damage to the affected bone during healing."
- C. "Weight-bearing activities can increase your body's inflammatory response."
- D. "It will reduce the risk of the infection spreading to other bones."

19. A client with a history of gout asks how they can prevent future attacks. Which recommendation should the nurse provide?

- A. "Consume high-purine foods to strengthen your joints."
- B. "Drink at least 8–10 glasses of water each day."
- C. "Limit your intake of dairy products."
- D. "Increase your intake of sugary drinks and fruit juice."

20. The nurse is assessing a client with osteoarthritis who complains of pain and limited mobility in the knees. Which of the following assessment findings is characteristic of OA?

- A. Bilateral joint swelling with systemic symptoms like fever
- B. Pain that improves with activity and worsens with rest
- C. Joint stiffness that worsens with rest and improves with movement
- D. Crepitus and pain with joint movement, especially in weight-bearing joints

21. A client is 48 hours post-cast application for a fractured tibia and complains of increasing pain not relieved by pain medication, along with a feeling of tightness under the cast. What is the nurse's priority action?

- A. Elevate the limb on pillows.
- B. Assess neurovascular status, including sensation and capillary refill.
- C. Apply a warm compress to reduce discomfort.
- D. Reassure the client that this is normal and part of the healing process.

22. A nurse is caring for a client with septic arthritis who is on intravenous (IV) antibiotics. Which laboratory value is most important to monitor to assess the client's response to treatment?

- A. Hemoglobin level.
- B. Erythrocyte sedimentation rate (ESR).
- C. Serum potassium.
- D. Blood urea nitrogen (BUN).

23. A nurse is assessing a 72-year-old client who has been diagnosed with osteoporosis and reports severe back pain. The client is unable to ambulate independently and says, "I feel like I'm getting shorter." The nurse determines the client is at risk for further complications related to this musculoskeletal disorder.

Which nursing diagnosis should the nurse prioritize for this client?

- A. Acute Pain related to muscle spasms and vertebral compression fractures
- B. Risk for Impaired Physical Mobility related to musculoskeletal impairment
- C. Impaired Skin Integrity related to decreased mobility and pressure on bony prominences
- D. Risk for Activity Intolerance related to chronic pain and muscle weakness

24. A client with osteoporosis asks about dietary changes to help improve bone health. Which of the following statements indicates that the client understands the dietary recommendations?

- A. "I will increase my intake of leafy green vegetables and fortified orange juice."
- B. "I need to limit my protein intake as it can weaken my bones."
- C. "I should increase my intake of red meat to get more calcium."
- D. "I will avoid foods high in vitamin D as they may worsen my condition."

25. The nurse demonstrates to a patient scheduled for a total hip replacement that it is important after surgery to avoid:

- a. Bearing weight on the affected leg after 4 to 6 weeks
- b. Sitting with the legs crossed
- c. Sleeping on the abdomen

d. Abduction exercises of the affected leg

26. A patient who has fallen and injured his wrist carefully cradles it with the other hand. The patient is demonstrating which of the following responses to pain?

a. Physiologic

b. Affective

c. Behavioral

d. Involuntary

27. A patient with a comminuted fracture of the femur is to have an open reduction with internal fixation (ORIF) of the fracture. The nurse explains that ORIF is indicated when:

a. Adequate alignment cannot be obtained by other nonsurgical methods.

b. The patient cannot tolerate the discomfort of a closed reduction.

c. Cast would be too large to provide normal mobility.

d. The patient is able to tolerate long-term immobilization.

28. During the postoperative period, the patient with an above-the-knee amputation should be instructed that the residual limb should not be routinely elevated because:

a. The flexed position can promote hip flexion contracture.

b. This position promotes clot formation at the incision site and thigh

c. This position reduces the development of phantom limb sensation

d. Unnecessary movement of the extremity can cause wound dehiscence